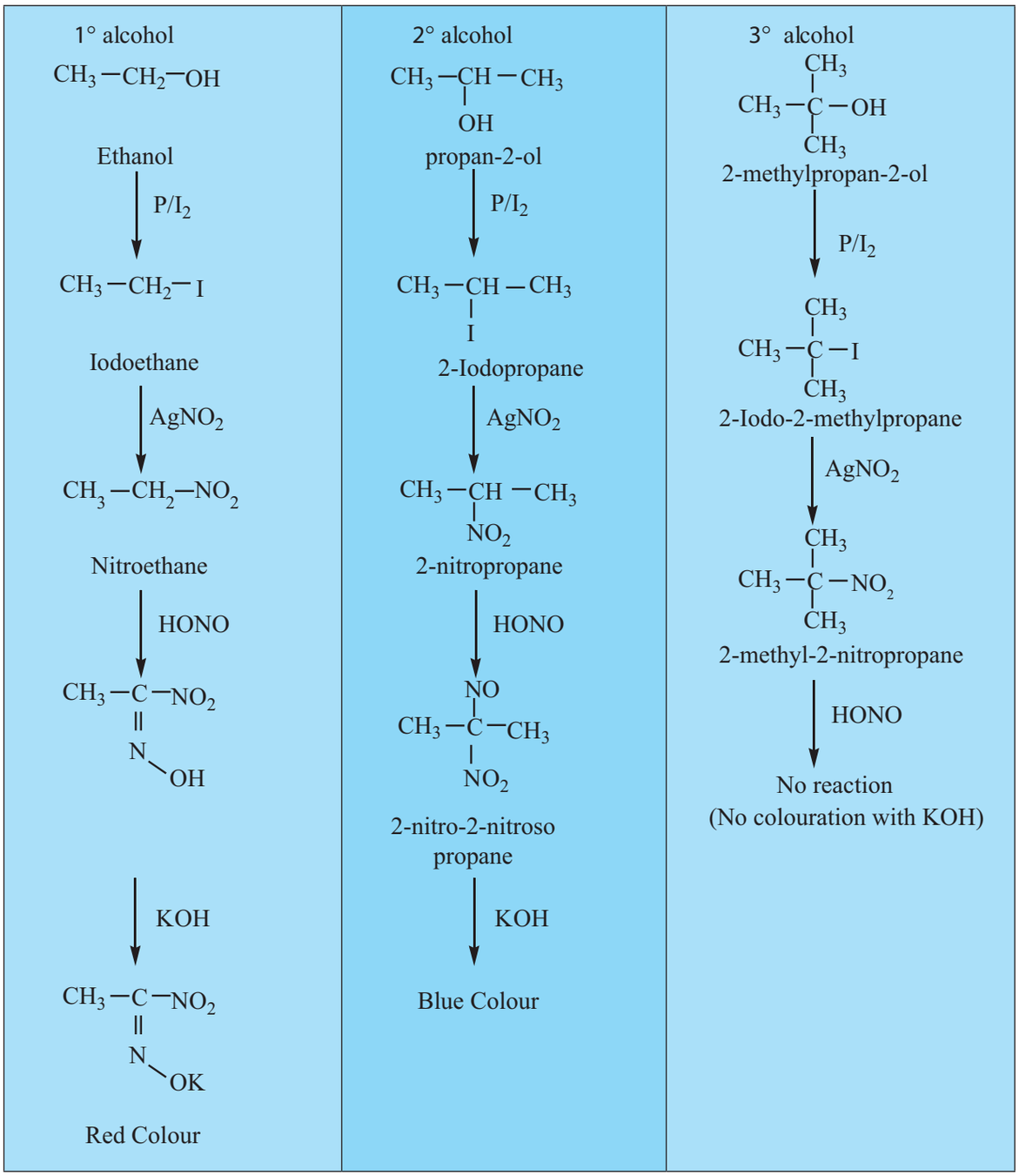


Properties of alcohols

Physical properties

i. Lower alcohols are colourless liquids and the higher members are waxy solids.

ii. They have higher boiling points than the corresponding other organic compounds such as alkanes, aldehydes, ethers etc., this is due to the presence of intermolecular hydrogen bonding present in alcohols.

iii. Among isomeric alcohols primary alcohols have higher boiling point and the tertiary alcohols have lower boiling points.

XII U11-Hydroxy compounds.indd 112 16-12-2022 19:42:01